A – Charter Changes Affecting Various City Departments and Commissions

Shall the City amend the Charter to align it with how some City departments currently operate, change some processes, eliminate or reorganize certain commissions and advisory bodies, and require the Board of Supervisors to amend voter-approved laws to enact some of these changes?

YES	◯
NO	◯

This measure requires 50%+1 affirmative votes to pass.

Digest by the Ballot Simplification Council

The Way It Is Now: The Charter is the City's constitution and establishes the organization, powers, and responsibilities for many City departments. The Charter and other voter-approved laws also create many City commissions and advisory bodies and describe their powers, duties, membership and removal rules, and reporting requirements.

Over time, some of these laws have become obsolete.

The Charter and most laws passed by the voters can only be changed with voter approval.

The Proposal: Proposition A would align the Charter with how some City departments currently operate, change some processes, and eliminate or reorganize certain commissions and advisory bodies. Proposition A would require the Board of Supervisors to amend voter-approved laws to enact some of these changes.

Proposition A would:

- change the language of the Charter to reflect how some City departments currently operate in order to clarify responsibilities and update rules, procedures, and reporting requirements.
- change some processes. For example: allowing legal settlements to be approved by resolution instead of by ordinance.
- require a task force to meet every ten years to recommend changes to commissions.
- eliminate or reorganize certain commissions and advisory bodies by, for example: eliminating some commissions and advisory bodies, combining and renaming some advisory bodies, and moving some commissions and advisory bodies from the Charter into the Municipal Code.

A "YES" Vote Means: If you vote "yes," you want to amend the Charter to align it with how some City departments currently operate, change some processes, eliminate or reorganize certain commissions and advisory bodies, and require the Board of Supervisors to amend voter-approved laws to enact some of these changes.

A "NO" Vote Means: If you vote "no," you do not want to make these changes.

Controller's Statement on "A"

City Controller Greg Wagner has issued the following statement on the fiscal impact of Proposition A:

Should the proposed Charter amendment be approved by the voters, in my opinion, it would have a moderate impact on the cost of government, saving $365,000 to $450,000 annually. Additional costs and savings are dependent on the decisions that the Mayor and Board of Supervisors make through the normal budget process.

The proposed Charter amendment (1) modifies boards, commissions, and advisory bodies; (2) changes departmental operations and reporting requirements; (3) changes how the Board of Supervisors must approve settlements or dismissals of legal proceedings recommended by the City Attorney; (4) removes provisions allowing disciplinary action against non-Police and Fire striking employees; and (5) makes other edits and changes to the Charter and past voter-approved ordinances. The Charter amendment may reduce required staff time to support boards, commissions, and advisory bodies—freeing staff to work on other government functions.

The proposed Charter amendment creates cost savings ranging from $365,000 to $450,000 annually by eliminating

The above statement is an impartial analysis of this measure. Arguments for and against this measure immediately follow.
The full text begins on page 148. Some of the words used in the ballot digest are explained starting on page 62.

the Sanitation and Streets Commission, Public Works Commission, and the Street Artists and Craftsmen Examiners Advisory Committee. The Sanitation and Streets Commission and Public Works Commission shared two full-time staff members with annual costs of $336,000.

Convening the Commission Streamlining Task Force (CSTF) every ten years would require staff to implement and administer the CSTF, including conducting analyses, writing public reports, and holding public meetings. The proposed Charter amendment removes the existing requirements for the Budget and Legislative Analyst to prepare a report and the City Attorney to prepare a draft Charter amendment implementing the CTSF's recommendations from CSTF's mandate. For context, convening the CSTF in 2025 required approximately 5,900 hours of staff time.

Additional costs and savings are dependent on the decisions that the Mayor and Board of Supervisors make through the normal budget process. For example, the proposed Charter amendment removes the restriction on compensating Youth Commission members which may lead to future costs, likely ranging from $5,000 to $85,000 annually, should policymakers seek compensation for the members. Certain appointive boards and commissions pay stipends to the commissioners on a per meeting basis ranging from $25 to $500 per meeting. Other commissioners are paid between $100 and $500 per month. Not all commissioners receive stipends. The amount of cost savings attributed to removing the requirement of hiring an executive secretary for commissions cannot be determined at this time as bodies may opt not to fill the position.

The proposed amendment updates commission responsibilities and membership requirements for remaining commissions and boards but will not directly impact the total cost to government. The amount of staff time needed to support commissions and boards may decrease—freeing staff to work on other government functions, although at a level that cannot be determined at this time.

Note that the proposed amendment would change the duties of the Controller's Office, which has prepared this statement.

How "A" Got on the Ballot

On July 14, 2026, the Board of Supervisors voted 9 to 2 to place Proposition A on the ballot. The Supervisors voted as follows:

Yes: Chen, Dorsey, Mahmood, Mandelman, Melgar, Sauter, Sherrill, Walton, Wong.

No: Chan, Fielder.